Idiot-Proof Sausage and Sun-Dried Tomato Pasta

with herbed ricotta and Parmesan

Prep Time:

20-30 min

Cook Within:

5 days

Difficulty:

Intermediate

Spice Level:

Mild

Nutrition (per serving)

Calories: 750

Carbs: 69g

Fat: 38g

Protein: 37g

Sodium: 1900mg

Contains: milk, wheat

Ingredients (Serves 2)

- 8 fl. oz. Tomato Sauce
- 8 oz. Italian Pork Sausage
- 5 oz. Rigatoni Pasta
- 2 oz. Part-Skim Ricotta Cheese
- 1 Shallot
- 1 oz. Creme Fraiche
- 1 oz. Sun Dried Tomato Pesto
- 1/2 oz. Shredded Parmesan Cheese
- 1/4 oz. Parsley
- 1/4 tsp. Red Pepper Flakes
- 1 tsp. Italian Seasoning Blend

You'll Need

- 1 Medium Pot
- 1 Mixing Bowl
- 1 Large Non-Stick Pan
- 1 Colander/Strainer

Before You Cook

- Wash hands thoroughly with soap and warm water before cooking and after handling raw meat or seafood
- Remove all produce from any packaging or constraints, then thoroughly rinse and pat dry
- Bring 8 cups water and 2 tsp. salt to a boil in a medium pot
- Ingredient(s) used more than once: parsley, red pepper flakes

Instructions

1. Cook the Pasta



Once water is boiling, add pasta and cook until al dente, 11-13 minutes.

Remove from burner. Reserve 1/2 cup pasta cooking water. Drain pasta in a colander/strainer.

While pasta cooks, continue recipe.

2. Prepare the Ingredients



Stem and finely chop parsley.

Peel and mince shallot.

In a mixing bowl, combine half the parsley (reserve remaining for sauce and garnish), ricotta, and a pinch of salt and pepper. Set aside.

3. Start the Sauce



Remove Italian sausage from casing, if necessary.

Place a large non-stick pan over medium-high heat and add 2 tsp. olive oil.

Add sausage and half the red pepper flakes (use less if spice-averse; reserve remaining for garnish) to hot pan and stir occasionally, breaking into 1" pieces, until browned and crisp, 3-5 minutes.

Add shallots and stir occasionally until softened and sausage reaches a minimum internal temperature of 160 degrees, 2-3 minutes.

4. Finish the Sauce



Stir Italian seasoning, pesto, and tomato sauce into hot pan until combined. Bring to a simmer.

Once simmering, stir occasionally until slightly thickened, 3-5 minutes.

Stir in creme fraiche and remaining parsley (reserve a couple pinches for garnish) until combined.

Season with salt and pepper to taste, as desired.

5. Add Pasta and Finish Dish



Add pasta to hot pan with sauce and stir until coated.

If too thick, add reserved pasta cooking water, 1 tsp. at a time, until desired consistency is reached.

Remove from burner. Stir in Parmesan until combined.

Plate dish as pictured on front of card, topping pasta with ricotta mixture and garnishing with remaining parsley and remaining red pepper flakes (to taste). Bon appétit!